



Routers under Rs. 3,000

Brand	D-Link	SMC Networks	BELKIN	SMC Networks	Linksys	ASUS
Model No	DIR-600	SMC 7901WBRA2	N150 Basic	SMCWBR14S-N4	WRT54GH	WL-520GU
Price (Rs.)	1,900	2,200	2,399	2,400	2,499	2,800
Grand Totals (Out of 100)	62.62	47.37	53.24	81.59	52.19	55.89
Features (Out of 20)	13.67	11.07	10.69	14.12	11.44	11.85
Performance (Out of 80)	48.95	36.30	42.55	67.47	40.75	44.04
Features						
Protocols Supported (802.11 a / b / g / Draft n / Draft 2)	N / Y / Y / N / N	N / Y / Y / N / N	N / Y / Y / Y / N	N / Y / Y / Y / N	N / Y / Y / N / N	N / Y / Y / N / N
Type Of WAN Port (Ethernet / ADSL / USB)	Ethernet	ADSL	Ethernet	Ethernet	Ethernet	Ethernet
No Of RJ45 (LAN) Ports	4	1	4	4	4	4
No Of USB Ports	0	1	1	1	0	1
Device Features:						
Power / Connectivity / LAN / Activity Indicators (Y/N)	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / N / N	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y
Security Indicator / Hardware Security button (Y / N)	Y	N / N	N / Y	N / Y	N / N	N / Y
Factory-Defaults Reset Button (Y / N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Wall Mountable (Y/N)	Y	Y	N	Y	Y	Y
External storage	N	N	N	N	N	N
3G / CDMA / data card feature	N	N	N	N	N	N
Security						
Encryption Types	WPA / WPA2	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WEP / WPA / WPA2
Firewall (Types Supported)	SPI / NAT	NAT / SPI	NAT	SPI / NAT	SPI	NAT / SPI
LAN I/P Based Site Blocking (Y/N)	Y	N	N	N	N	N
Wireless Isolation (Y/N)	Y	N	N	Y	N	N
Port Mapping (Forwarding)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Firmware Interface Features:						
Basic Setup Wizard (CD / Browser) (Y / N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	N
Online / Offline Firmware Upgrade (Y/N)	Y	N / Y	N / Y	Y / Y	N / Y	N / Y
Settings, Backup To HDD / Load From HDD (Y / N)	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y
Ease of Installation/Use (So 10)						
Bundle (Includes Software, except firmware)	6	6	6	6.5	6	6
Firmware Interface	6.5	6	5	6.5	6.5	6
Device Configurable Settings	6.5	6.5	5	6	6	6
Build Quality	6	6	5.5	5	6	5.5
Performance						
Zone 1 (100 MB File transfer)						
Signal Strength in Zone 1 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %)	66	68	66	63	63	62
Sequential (MBps)	2.28	3.17	3.73	5.02	2.47	2.43
Assorted files (MBps)	1.53	4.64	2.39	2.89	1.47	1.78
Zone 2 (50 MB File transfer)						
Signal Strength in Zone 2 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %)	16	43	38	48	46	56
Sequential (MBps)	1.17	2.44	2.31	4.11	2.66	2.47
Assorted files (MBps)	0.95	1.73	2.69	3.00	1.66	1.98
Zone 3 (50 MB File transfer)						
Signal Strength in Zone 3 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %)	20	0	13	26	8	25
Sequential (MBps)	1.12	0	0.26	1.63	0.35	0.37
Assorted files (MBps)	0.89	0	0.25	0.88	0.83	0.17
Passmark Performance (Mbps)						
Zone 1	3.68	2.56	3.35	4.83	2.6	2.65
Zone 2	3.57	2.68	3.89	4.14	2.73	2.71
Zone 3	0.57	0	0.08	0.48	0.85	0.20
Video Streaming (So 10)						
HD 1080p - Zone 1 / 2 / 3	8 / 8 / 5	5 / 6 / 0	8 / 5 / 2	8 / 8 / 8	3 / 4 / 2	8 / 8 / 2
DVD - Zone 1 / 2 / 3	8 / 8 / 6	8 / 8 / 0	6 / 6 / 3	8 / 8 / 8	6 / 6 / 4	8 / 8 / 3

firmware too, is identical to the WL-520GU. The firmware of the router where the ASUS RT-N13U excels the most. There are tons of features and options available to the user. One of the key features of the firmware is the EzQoS Bandwidth Management feature which allows you to switch profiles of the router by the press of a mouse click. There are presets to improvement priority for gaming, internet apps, media streaming and the USB FTP function. The ability to plug in a flash drive and use it as an

external storage is added bonus. Most of the advanced features are accessible from a single page. On most routers, one needs to go from menu to submenus multiple depths in. The interface is very interactive as well unlike most other routers.

The Buffalo WHR-HP-GN has a very compact sleek design. There are no status indicators at the front of the router but they are right next to the connections at the back. The router is lightweight and the bundle comes with an ultra thin Eth-

ernet cable. As a package, it's one of the nicer products. The interface on the firmware isn't as pretty as the hardware itself. The main page is useful and has all the information on the features in the router. All the other menus have huge fonts and somewhat weird colours. This makes you wonder what Buffalo were thinking while designing this product. Belkin's N300 Surf has a simple design. It stands vertically but with only one LED display which isn't the simplest to use.

Performance

Not only is the ASUS RT-N13U great in its appearance, features and firmware, but it's also great at performance. It performed flawlessly through all the video streaming tests. File transfer tests across all the zones were pretty good. The Buffalo WHR-HP-GN isn't far behind either. It might not be the prettiest of routers or have special features as compared to the rest, but it sure performs well. Even in the Zone 3 tests, it managed 2.12 MBps speeds in the Passmark while